cargo. However I think he knows his profession and we may get rid of him entirely in a few days. If it is in any way possible I will not fail to avenge Twiggs insults but do not take any notice of what has passed until the whole cargo is out of his hands. Mr. Ellis's letter has been of the greatest service in the arrangement of the duty questions. Lord Ponsonby[37] has exerted himself much and sees the matter quite in the same light I do, he has also been very confidential with me on Eastern politics of which he takes a very just view. Although we have not succeeded in altogether escaping the duties we have got off so much of them that the amount to be paid will be very trifling.

I this day send home to Messrs Spooner Atwoods two bills drawn at 61 days sight dated 30th July for £1000 each. I send them to Messrs Atwoods as you may probably be out of town when the letter arrives and as our joint note of hand will probably be about coming due. When these get to hand I am very anxious the bills should be accepted as soon as possible. I send you on the other sheet a copy of the letter I write to Mr Atwood on the subject, which I hope you will approve of. You can get the bills from the bank, discount them in the most favourable manner you can and take back our note of hand which you will be kind enough to destroy. When you next write will you be kind enough to send out a complete and formal account current, which may serve as a document for us in any case, of the justice and absolute necessity of this I am sure you will be convinced, and also on a slip of paper separate an extract from the Bill book with all outstanding engagements.

I now come to a subject on which it is exceedingly difficult for me to write and which I premise by assuring you that in any thing I may do or say I am actuated only by sincere feeling for the general welfare of the family, and the more I think on that subject the more strongly the conclusion is forced upon me that we ought to be as distinct as possible and that in saving Edward and myself you are doing that which is most likely to in future conduce to the well being of the family. I consider it of the last importance that you should endeavour by all means in your power to liquidate our account, and keep our general credit good. I cannot help looking forward to a prosperous result to this adventure, and if it pleases God to grant this I think you cannot doubt that Edward and myself would in every respect participate with the whole family. Regarding making arrangements with Hansons for any *present* advances it is totally out of my power to do so as I am already tresspassing most largely on Charles Hansons kindness and confidence. The whole responsibility of my advances is thrown upon him and he very kindly allows me to take all my goods forward to Persia without re[que]sting anything to cover the very large amount advanced. This

[37] British ambassador at Constantinople.

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